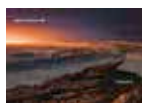




Grey hair can regain colour

A finding suggests that grey hair can sometimes regain colour when individuals feel less stress. <https://digit.in/jun20-36>



Proxima b confirmed

Researchers confirmed the existence of Proxima b, an Earth-like planet orbiting Proxima Centauri. <https://digit.in/jun20-37>

well. At that time, the Chinese Navy was actually ahead of its European counterparts, and the course of world history could have been significantly different if the Chinese had continued their naval tradition.

PHOENICIA

The Phoenicians were a group of people that originated from Lebanon, and established trading posts throughout the southern Mediterranean. Their main commodity of trade was the Cedar woods. They traded goods between Africa, Greece, Rome, Sicily and Spain, including gold and tin. They were considered to be a lost civilisation because there are very few surviving records that the Phoenicians made of themselves. However, the Phoenician alphabet was adapted to form the Greek alphabet, which in turn was the basis for the Latin alphabet, used all around the world today to write English. The Phoenicians traded from between 1500 BCE to 200 BCE, establishing a number of independent city states similar to the ones in Greece. It is unclear if they considered themselves to be a contiguous civilisation. These city states grew out of trading posts, and one of them eventually became a major civilisation in its own right, Carthage. Ships from Carthage went all the way to Britain, and the Phoenicians even navigated out of the Mediterranean to trade with settlements on the Atlantic coast of Africa. According to Herodotus, a Phoenician expedition even managed to circumnavigate Africa, on the urging of the Egyptian

Pharaoh, Necho. The Bible mentions a Phoenician expedition to an island called Ophir to obtain ivory, gold, silver and gems. Ophir has not been identified, but could be Sudan, Yemen or an Island in the Indian Ocean. A cache of Phoenician coins from 200 BCE has been discovered in the remote island of Corvo in the Azores, in the middle of the Atlantic ocean. It is unclear how they got there, but a Carthagian expedition is suspected.

The Phoenician ships were up to a hundred feet long, used a single large square sail, and the anchors were made out of hollowed-out wood filled with lead. The wooden ships were so finely crafted with close fitting parts that there was absolutely no need to caulk them, which is a process of using material to waterproof the gaps between planks. They were additionally propelled by teams of oarsmen. The ships were the peak of seafaring vessels during their time, and the Romans copied their naval designs directly from the Phoenicians.

The Phoenicians did not have a compass or sextant, and used the Sun and the stars for navigation, as well as landmarks on the coastline. For years, researchers believed that the Phoenicians only sailed along the coastlines, but there is evidence to suggest that they might have taken shorter and

straighter routes to known islands in clear weather conditions.

PUNT

The Kingdom of Punt (modern day Somalia) was an important intermediary between the east and the west, having trade links across the Indian Ocean and into the Red Sea. They traded with the Phoenicians, Egyptians and Greeks, but at the same time with Malaysia, the Arabs, India



Model of a Beden ship

and even China. Their most important goods for trade were camphor, frankincense and spices, which they did not make themselves but procured from Indian merchants. One of the most lucrative businesses was the trade of cinnamon, which was also sourced from India or China. The Greeks and Romans believed that the cinnamon originated in Punt.

The ancient Somali traders used ships known as Beden, which was essentially the same basic design in different sizes. The planks of the boat were stitched together with the coir made from coconut fibre (yes, it is the same sutli used in Indian households). The fishing boats were between 20-50 feet in length and called Beden-seyed, the trading vessels were 50 feet in length and called Beden-safar, while the really large merchant vessels were called Uwassiye, and were in excess of 75 feet in length. The boats had rectangular sails with single masts. This is another one of those timeless successful designs that continues to be used to this day. 



A Phoenician ship leaving Carthage